

Year	Annual Percentage Change		
	in Per-Share Book Value of Berkshire	in S&P 500 with Dividends Included	Relative Results
	(1)	(2)	(1) – (2)
1998	48.3	28.6	19.7
1999	0.5	21.0	(20.5)
2000	6.5	(9.1)	15.6
2001	(6.2)	(11.9)	5.7
2002	10.0	(22.1)	32.1
2003	21.0	28.7	(7.7)
2004	10.5	10.9	(0.4)
2005	6.4	4.9	1.5
2006	18.4	15.8	2.6
2007	11.0	5.5	5.5
2008	(9.6)	(37.7)	27.4
2009	19.8	26.5	(6.7)
2010	13.0	15.1	(2.1)
2011	4.6	2.1	2.5
2012	14.4	16.0	(1.6)
Compounded Annual Gain, 1965–2012	19.7%	9.4%	10.3
Overall Gain, 1964–2012	586,817%	7,433%	

On sheer numbers, then—superior performance sustained over long periods—it’s hard to argue with the statement that Warren Buffett is the world’s greatest investor. But what if we look beyond the numbers?

The Private Buffett

How should we think about a man who began managing money when Dwight Eisenhower was president and continues to play the game well almost six decades later?

When he was not yet a teenager, young Buffett announced to anyone and everyone that he was going to be a millionaire by age 30 and if not he would jump off the tallest building in Omaha. He was joking, of course—about the jumping-off part—and even the millionaire ambition wasn’t what we might expect. Today, he has far exceeded that youngster’s goal, but those who know Buffett well know he cares little for the billionaire’s